

Security+ 4.2 · Asset Management

Master CyberSec — Official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) Comprehensive Study Guide · **Lesson 4.2 — Asset Management (8:37)** · [Official YouTube Video ↗](#) · [Professor Messer Study Hub ↗](#)

Executive Lesson Summary: Asset management: procurement (standardized purchasing); tracking (inventory, tagging, database); WORM (write once read many — immutable, anti-ransomware); media sanitization (wipe/degauss/physical destruction before disposal).

High-Yield Core Concepts Tested on Exam

- WORM storage: write once, never modify — immutable
- Media sanitization: wipe, degauss, physical shredding
- Asset tracking: inventory, tagging, and database
- Procurement: standardized purchasing reduces risk
- WORM is effective against ransomware encryption

Exam Tips & Classic Scenarios

- 'storage that cannot be modified after write' = WORM
- 'securely disposing of old hard drives' = media sanitization
- 'inventory and tagging' = asset tracking

Typical Exam Scenario: 'Backup stored on storage that cannot be altered' = WORM (immutable).

Beyond the Video: Official CompTIA Exam Concepts, Protocols & Traps (Lesson 4.2 — Asset Management)

Why is this advanced coverage required for SY0-701? Video overviews provide foundational familiarity, but CompTIA tests practical engineering judgment and requires deep familiarity with the following protocols, acronyms, and operational nuances in this domain:

- **DLP:** Data Loss Prevention: Software/hardware safeguards monitoring, identifying, and preventing unauthorized exfiltration of sensitive organizational assets in use, transit, or rest.
- **WORM:** Write Once, Read Many: Immutable optical/cloud storage paradigm preventing data alteration or deletion during retention periods (critical for audit logs).

Classic CompTIA Traps & Question Framing:

- Avoid rote memorization: CompTIA exam prompts regularly adjust technical constraints requiring you to defend why one valid security control is the *MOST appropriate* or *FIRST step*.
- Scrutinize question qualifiers: 'without additional licensing costs' favors native OS tools; 'granular administrative command accounting' favors TACACS+ over RADIUS; 'non-repudiation' mandates asymmetric private key signing.

Practice Questions with In-Depth Solutions (10 Questions)

Detailed answer key with step-by-step technical rationale and comprehensive distractor breakdown provided below. Attempt answering independently first.

1. A control that prevents an employee from sending a confidential spreadsheet outside the company is:

- A)** DLP (Data Loss Prevention)
- B)** SSO
- C)** MFA
- D)** VPN

2. Corporate scenario (Asset Management): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.2), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'WORM storage: write once, never change again — immutable'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Implement the corresponding solution: WORM storage: write once, never change again — immutable
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials

3. Corporate scenario (Asset Management): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.2), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'Media sanitization: wipe, degauss, physical shred'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials
- D)** Implement the corresponding solution: Media sanitization: wipe, degauss, physical shred...

4. Corporate scenario (Asset Management): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.2), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'storage that cannot be modified after write'=WORM'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'storage that cannot be modified after write'=WORM...
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

5. Corporate scenario (Asset Management): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.2), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'securely disposing of old hard drives' = media sanitization. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'securely disposing of old hard drives' = media sanitization...
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials

6. Corporate scenario (Asset Management): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.2), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: "backup stored on storage that cannot be altered"=WORM (immutable).' What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'backup stored on storage that cannot be altered'=WORM (immutable)...
- B)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials

7. Corporate scenario (Asset Management): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.2), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'WORM storage: write once, never alter again — immutable'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials
- D)** Implement the corresponding solution: WORM storage: write once, never alter again — immutable...

8. Corporate scenario (Asset Management): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.2), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'Media sanitization: wipe, degauss, physical shred'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Implement the corresponding solution: Media sanitization: wipe, degauss, physical shred...
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

9. Corporate scenario (Asset Management): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.2), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'storage that cannot be modified after write' = WORM. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to speed up system throughput
- B)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'storage that cannot be modified after write' = WORM...
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

10. Corporate scenario (Asset Management): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.2), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'securely disposing of old hard drives' = media sanitization'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'securely disposing of old hard drives' = media sanitization...
- B)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

COMPREHENSIVE ANSWER KEY & DISTRACTOR BREAKDOWN

1) A — DLP (Data Loss Prevention).

✓ **Why it's correct:** DLP (Data Loss Prevention) is a set of technologies and policies aimed at preventing the exfiltration of confidential data by monitoring and controlling transfers of sensitive information. In CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701), DLP is presented as a control that can block the sending of data outside the organization, whether via email, web, USB, or other channels. The question describes exactly a control that prevents an employee from sending a confidential spreadsheet outside the company, which is the primary function of DLP.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- **SSO:** SSO (Single Sign-On) is an authentication mechanism that allows a user to access multiple systems with a single credential. It does not control data transfer or prevent information exfiltration. Therefore, it does not apply to the described scenario.
- **MFA:** MFA (Multi-Factor Authentication) is an authentication method that requires two or more verification factors to grant access. It strengthens authentication but does not prevent an authorized user from sending confidential data outside. It is not a data loss prevention control. Thus, it is not the correct answer.
- **VPN:** VPN (Virtual Private Network) is a technology that creates an encrypted tunnel for secure communication, but it does not have the function of inspecting or blocking the transfer of confidential data. It protects transmission but does not prevent exfiltration by an authorized user. Therefore, it does not meet the requirement of the question.

2) B — Implement the corresponding solution: WORM storage: write once, never change again — immutable.

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.2 (Asset Management): WORM storage: write once, never change again — immutable. WORM (Write Once Read Many) storage ensures data immutability, which is critical for compliance and tamper-proof archiving.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

3) D — Implement the corresponding solution: Media sanitization: wipe, degauss, physical shred....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.2 (Asset Management): Media sanitization: wipe, degauss, physical shred. These methods ensure data is irrecoverable from storage media.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detect incidents and breaks

compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).

- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

4) C — Implement the corresponding solution: 'storage that cannot be modified after write'=WORM....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.2 (Asset Management): WORM (Write Once Read Many) storage cannot be modified after write, ensuring data integrity and immutability for compliance and forensic purposes.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to incident detection and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user conduct and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

5) B — Implement the corresponding solution: 'securely disposing of old hard drives' = media sanitization....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.2 (Asset Management): 'securely disposing of old hard drives' = media sanitization. Media sanitization is the process of securely removing data from storage media to prevent unauthorized recovery, which is essential when disposing of old hard drives. This matches the requirement.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* This directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detect incidents and violates compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user behavior and do not block automated attacks, injections, or runtime malware.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* This destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

6) A — Implement the corresponding solution: 'backup stored on storage that cannot be altered'=WORM (immutable)....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.2 (Asset Management): 'backup stored on storage that cannot be altered'=WORM (immutable). WORM (Write Once Read Many) storage ensures data immutability, protecting backups from ransomware or tampering.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput*: Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence*: Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user behavior and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials*: Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

7) D — Implement the corresponding solution: WORM storage: write once, never alter again — immutable....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.2 (Asset Management): WORM storage: write once, never alter again — immutable. WORM (Write Once, Read Many) storage ensures that data, once written, cannot be modified or deleted for a specified retention period. This immutability is crucial for maintaining the integrity of audit logs, legal holds, and compliance data, protecting against tampering and ransomware. It is a preventive and detective control for data integrity and availability.

✗ **Why the other options are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput*: This directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and violates compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence*: Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user behavior and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials*: This destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

8) B — Implement the corresponding solution: Media sanitization: wipe, degauss, physical shred....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.2 (Asset Management): Media sanitization: wipe, degauss, physical shred. Media sanitization involves methods to securely remove data from storage media before disposal or reuse, including software wiping, degaussing (for magnetic media), and physical destruction (shredding). The appropriate action is to implement the corresponding solution, which includes establishing a media sanitization policy and procedures.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput*: Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence*: Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user behavior and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials*: Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

9) B — Implement the corresponding solution: 'storage that cannot be modified after write' = WORM....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.2 (Asset Management): 'storage that cannot be modified after write' = WORM. WORM (Write Once Read Many) is a data storage technology that prevents modification or deletion after data is written, ensuring data integrity and immutability. It is used for compliance, legal holds, and tamper-proof archiving. The appropriate control is to implement the corresponding solution, such as WORM storage, which enforces data immutability and supports non-repudiation.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to speed up system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to incident detection and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user behavior and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

10) A — Implement the corresponding solution: 'securely disposing of old hard drives'=media sanitization....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.2 (Asset Management): 'securely disposing of old hard drives'=media sanitization. Media sanitization ensures that data is irrecoverably removed from storage media before disposal or reuse, using methods such as wiping, degaussing, or physical destruction.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to incident detection and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user conduct and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.